FAR EASTERN UNIVERSITY
Institute of Arts and Sciences
Department of Psychology

"Growing Up Between Two Homes": A Phenomenological Study of the Lived Experiences of Young Adults from Co-Parenting Families After Parental Separation

PSY1205: Field Methods in Psychology

2nd Semester A.Y 2025 - 2026

Section 23

Crisostomo, Gia

Dela Cruz, Georgine Kyla

Geneta, Geanille C.

Geronimo, Xynith Jigary M.

Mena, Cyrin Grace M.

Verayo, Rayzel Ann M.

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Background of the Study

When parents separate, the children are often forced to balance life between two different households, which can impact their daily realities and sense of self. Young adults raised in co-parenting environments face distinct challenges, including managing conflicting expectations from parents, coping with divided attention, adjusting to different routines and environments in each home. Although co-parenting arrangements are increasingly common, there remains a limited in-depth understanding of how these experiences are actually lived and perceived by young adults following parental separation.

Furthermore, early exposure to such relationship dynamics can shape their capacity to form trust and intimacy bonds in current and future relationships. The foundational experience of family relationships often extends well beyond adolescence, how individuals approach conflict, express emotions, and establish a sense of personal safety in adulthood. This accentuates the need for further research and development focused on subjective realities of children from separated parents, as well as the development of meaningful support systems rooted in their actual experiences.

Co-parenting has been observed in other countries, especially in Western Countries such as the United States. However the lived experiences of the young adults from the parenting styles in a Philippines context is important to understand due to the differing socio-cultural environments and systematic issues they face compared to their western counterparts.

Research Problem

This study aims to explore the lived experiences of young adults from co-parenting families following parental separation, applying a phenomenological approach to understand the essence of growing up between two households. This study seeks to address the following research problems:

1. What are the lived experiences of young adults with parental separation?
2. How do young adults describe and make sense of the possible coping strategies they develop in response to their experiences of parental separation?
3. How do young adults describe the experiences of parental separation to them as they grow older?
4. How do young adults describe the possible influence of their co-parenting upbringing on their platonic and romantic relationships?
5. In what ways do these experiences influence how young adults view commitment, trust, and emotional closeness in their relationships?

Although prior research has been documented on parental separation and its effects on children, there is a significant gap between understanding possible impacts of co-parenting after separation and subjective experience of growing up between two homes. Therefore, this study aims to explore the lived experiences of Filipino young adults in Metro Manila, to understand their individual and personal perspectives with co-parenting.

The psychological effects are influenced by factors such as parent–child attachment, the meaning given to life circumstances, and the coping strategies employed, suggesting that strong emotional support and adaptive coping are critical protective factors for maintaining psychological well-being in the context of family disruption. In an Indonesian phenomenological study by Firdausi et al. (2020), the findings revealed that young people

often perceive themselves as living with feelings of misfortune and profound unhappiness. A discordant home environment, as described by participants, contributes to experiences of maladaptive behaviors among peers, including aggression, defiance, and social withdrawal.

Assumptions of the Study

Significance of the Study

Many young people who have experienced parental separation describe navigating difficult emotional landscapes, including feelings of anxiety, fear, sadness, and behavioral struggles that continue to shape their lives as they grow older (Syahdariani, 2025). A broader review of existing literature also indicates that parental divorce or separation is often accompanied by struggles during adolescence, such as difficulties in school, early substance use, and persistent low mood, although many individuals also speak of developing resilience over time (D'Onofrio & Emery, 2019). These findings show why it is important to understand not only the short term effects but also how separation can shape an individual's feelings and coping even into young adulthood.

This study is crucial as it focuses on Filipino college students ages 18–25 years old who grew up in co-parenting arrangements where both parents remain involved after separation. Young adults in these conditions may face unique struggles such as conflicting parental expectations, divided attention, and adjusting to different home environments but there is still limited understanding of how these experiences affect their sense of security, belonging, and family connectedness, and how they cope emotionally. Gaining deeper insight

can help schools, guidance counselors, and mental health professionals design better support systems that match what young adults actually experience. The study also guides the separated parents in improving co-parenting practices that protect the child's well being and promote a healthier adjustment after separation.

Scope & Limitations

Scope of the Study

This study will focus on Filipino college students aged 18–25 who have separated parents but still experience an active co-parenting arrangement, meaning both parents continue to provide support and maintain parental roles in their lives despite no longer being together. For the purposes of this study, parental separation refers to parents who live separately but continue to share parenting responsibilities, regardless of whether the separation is legally formalized. The setting of the study is in the University Belt area in Manila. This location is chosen because the researchers are based in Far Eastern University Manila, and it is more realistic for recruitment and interviews. The study will explore the lived experiences of these young adults and how parental separation relates to their sense of security, belonging, and family connectedness.

Limitations of the Study

This study has limits based on its design and boundaries. Since this is a qualitative phenomenological study, the goal is to understand experiences in depth so the findings are not meant to represent all Filipino young adults in the same situation. The sample will also be small and purposely selected consisting of approximately 8–12 participants, which is appropriate for phenomenological research that focuses on exploring lived experiences rather than generalizing results. Phenomenological studies typically involve small samples because they require detailed interviews and intensive analysis, and scholars suggest that this type of research may include around 5 to 25 participants (Creswell, 2013; Moustakas, 1994). Another limitation is that the study does not specifically require participants whose parents are legally separated or annulled. Due to the rarity and legal complexity of formal marital dissolution in the Philippines, the study focuses primarily on individuals whose parents are informally separated but continue practicing co-parenting, which may limit the applicability of the findings to legally separated families.

Furthermore, there may be recall and self report bias due to the participants being asked to reflect on past experiences that can be emotional and some details may be forgotten or remembered differently over time. Social desirability bias is also possible especially when talking about family conflict, coping, or sensitive topics. Another limitation is researcher bias during interpretation of interview data, the researchers will manage this by using bracketing and peer debriefing. Lastly, Filipino cultural values related to family, respect for authority, and keeping family issues private may influence what participants choose to share which can limit how transferable the findings are to other contexts.

Theoretical Framework and Conceptual Paradigm

Attachment Theory, originally developed by John Bowlby in the 1960s, describes how young children develop relationships. The theory suggests that infants would benefit from a secure attachment to at least one primary caregiver for emotional and social development. Bowlby noted that infants have an innate need to form secure attachment to a consistent caregiver, as this secure attachment is associated with a foundation for a sense of safety, emotional regulation, and social development. Additionally, when the primary caregiver provides sufficient care when an infant signals a physical and emotional need, the infant may begin to develop a secure relationship with the caregiver. In contrast, when there is a prolonged inconsistency or disruption in caregiving, this may be associated with insecure attachment patterns. This insecurity may be reflected in adulthood in terms of challenges in forming stable and trusting relationships. For instance, in the context of parental separation, the absence of one or both parents is associated with how individuals behave in romantic relationships and their emotional and psychological well-being (Hutchinson, 2025). The Attachment Theory serves as a basis to understand further how the participants derive meaning from their experiences in parental separation and co-parenting.

Definition of Terms

The terms used, defined as a multi-dimensional state of the young adult's state of mental health, encompasses emotional stability, autonomy, and ability to form a healthy relationship looking forward to adulthood despite the parental separation. To further understand the study, the following terms were defined contextually that refers to *lived experiences* of the young adults in which their childhood and adolescence revolved between two distinct parental households.

1. **Attachment** - The emotional bond formed between child and caregiver influencing relationships and emotion regulation (Hutchinson, 2025).
2. **Belongingness** - Feelings of being accepted, valued, and connected to family or significant relationships (Johnsen et al., 2018).
3. **Co-parenting** - Separated parents sharing responsibilities and remaining actively involved in the child's life (D'Onofrio & Emery, 2019).
4. **Coping Mechanisms** - Strategies used to manage stress and emotional challenges (Syahdariani, 2025).
5. **Emotional Regulation** - The ability to monitor, evaluate, and adjust emotional responses to maintain balance and achieve personal or social goals (Chaulagain et al., 2019).
6. **Emotional Resilience** - The ability to adapt to stressful situations, managing the emotions regularly. (American Psychological Association, 2025)
7. **Lived Experiences** - Personal perceptions and interpretations of events in one's life (Johnsen et al., 2018).
8. **Marital Separation -** Separation may be informal via mutual agreement or legally arranged via an official, enforceable document. (APA, 2026)
9. **Mistrust** - The suspicion and doubt regarding someone's intention, honesty, and situation reliability. (APA PsychNet, 2026)

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

The Crucial Emotional and Psychological Effects of Parental Separation on Young Adults

According to Hess (2022), ongoing conflicts between parents can severely disrupt family communication. In difficult environments, children often feel a painful sense of divided loyalty, feeling as though they must choose between their parents (Johnsen et al., 2018). Furthermore, parental infidelity frequently leads the child to withdraw from academic pursuits, develop deep mistrust, and have difficulties in forming committed relationships in the future (Siguan et al., 2021). In the broader context of adolescent mental health shows that there are approximately 10-20% of adolescents from ages 10 to 19 experiencing mental health conditions worldwide (Chaulagain et al., 2019). In a more alarming rate, the Philippines' data shows that 16.8% of adolescents ages 13 to 17, have attempted suicide at least once (Malolos et al., 2021).

Among students that experience parental separation, the common difficulties include forced independence, academic pressure, mental health challenges, and increased family conflict. In Grotan et al. (2019)'s observation, the growing normalization of family separations has obscured the traditional ideal and values of family relationships. This specific matter is crucial to navigate in Filipino society, as mental illness ranks third as the most common disability in the country.

Living in Two Worlds

Parental separation serves as a major stressor for children, with potential long-term consequences including impaired emotional health in adulthood and diminished educational attainment. The literature emphasizes that the separation event itself is often less impactful than the surrounding environmental and relational variables. According to Sadowski and McIntosh (2016), factors such as the intensity of parental conflict before and after the divorce, the parents' capacity for cooperation in the child's best interest, and the child's continued contact with both parents are the primary determinants of psychological well-being. Furthermore, the economic and material stability of the post-divorce household plays a crucial role in mediating these outcomes. Chronic interparental discord, in particular, is highlighted as a critical risk factor that heightens a child's sense of guilt and erodes their self-esteem, suggesting that for joint custody to be successful, parents must prioritize low conflict levels and maintain a communicative environment where shared family experiences are still validated.

Beyond these structural factors, the lived experience of the child involves a profound transition where their established "lifeworld" is perceived to collapse. This shift from a two-parent household to two single-parent residences often initiates a period of acute instability and insecurity, as children navigate the cycle of breaking up and re-establishing homes. (Johnsen et al., 2018) Emotional vulnerability is frequently exacerbated when children feel caught in the tension between parents, feeling "dragged" between competing loyalties. The memory of the separation itself is often indelible; the specific moment of disclosure is frequently seared into a child's memory, creating "flashbulb" associations that lead them to avoid certain activities or places linked to that trauma. Whether the separation was a result of chronic tension or was completely unexpected, the transition period remains a

pivotal experience characterized by a profound fear of the future and a struggle to regain a sense of domestic security.

Effects of Parental Separation on the Psychosocial Well-being of Child's Development

Parental separation is a widespread issue with significant implications for children's emotional, social, and academic development. Children experiencing the dissolution of their parents' relationship often go through complex emotions as they adapt to changes within the family. A study conducted by Sabillo (2024) of a junior high school student in Sarangani Province, Philippines revealed considerable disruption in the student's daily life and loss of stability and sense of security with their parents, resulting in heightened feelings of stress and anxiety. These negative effects extended into the child's social relationships, academic engagement, and capacity to build healthy connections with peers and adults. It also highlighted that families with strong emotional bonds are better equipped to address challenges in constructive and positive methods.

Recognizing the ripple effects of parental separation could enable parents, caregivers, and professionals to collaborate in offering appropriate guidance and interventions that promote healthy coping and long-term well-being. It is essential for parents to remain attentive to their children's emotional needs throughout and after the separation process.

Conceptual Framework

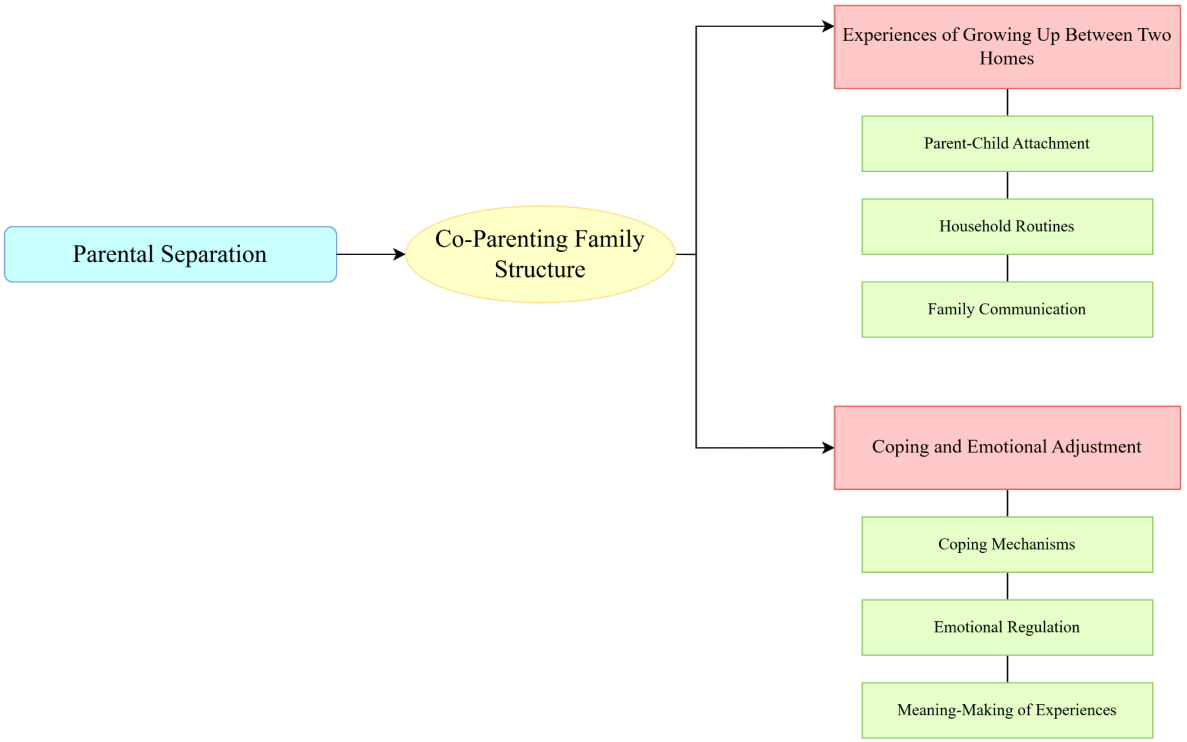

Figure 2. Illustrates the Lived Experiences Among Young Adults from Co-Parenting Families After Separation

Parental Separation is the initial event that disrupts family stability and introduces emotional and environmental challenges for children (D'Onofrio & Emery, 2019). This leads to a co-parenting family structure, where both parents remain actively involved and provide guidance, support, and consistent parenting across separate households (Qiao et. al., 2024; Hess, 2022).

Growing up between two homes involves managing parent-child attachment, household routines, and communication with each parent, while negotiating conflicting expectations and adjusting to different household norms, which may foster independence and adaptability unique to young adults from co-parenting families (Johnsen et al., 2018). Coping and emotional adjustment mediate these experiences, as participants develop personal

strategies such as emotional reflection, solving conflict, and finding meaning in their dual-home experiences to maintain balance and navigate both social and familial relationships.

Psychological well-being in young adulthood includes a sense of security, belongingness, self-esteem, emotional resilience, and interpersonal relationships, shaped by earlier family experiences and influenced by cultural values such as family loyalty and respect for elders (Siguan et al., 2021; Hutchinson, 2025). These arrows in the figure show the flow from family events to experiences, coping processes, and psychological outcomes. - Gia (to be revise)

CHAPTER 3

METHODOLOGY

Research Method

This study will employ a descriptive phenomenological research design to explore and describe the lived experiences of young adults who grew up in co-parenting arrangements following parental separation. A phenomenological approach is appropriate because the study aims to understand how individuals interpret and make meaning of their experiences within a co-parenting family structure. Qualitatively, the study focuses on capturing participants' personal narratives, perceptions, and reflections regarding their sense of security, belonging, coping strategies, and interpersonal relationships while growing up in a co-parenting environment. Through this approach, the researchers aim to identify common themes and patterns that characterize the experiences of individuals raised in such family arrangements.

Data will be collected through semi structured interviews conducted online, allowing the researchers to follow a prepared interview guide while also providing flexibility for participants to elaborate on their experiences and share perspectives that may not have been anticipated by the researchers. The interview questions will explore key aspects of the participants' experiences, including family dynamics, their experiences with co-parenting arrangements, and how these experiences have shaped their personal development and relationships.

Instruments and Data Collection

The data collection instrument for this study is a semi-structured interview. The interview will be based on the well-being and lived experiences of young adults—ranging

from 18–25 years old—residing in Metro Manila with co-parenting after their parents have separated, which will provide answers for the study's statement of the problem. Moreover, the recruitment tool the researchers will utilize is Google Forms. The researchers will utilize Google Meet as the primary internet-mediated research tool for conducting the interviews. The interview proper will be recorded to ensure accuracy of the collected data. The data collection process is carried out through the following sequential and systematic steps:

1. First is the recruitment stage. The researchers are set to recruit participants via posting on different social media platforms such as Facebook and Instagram using a poster indicating the purpose of the study, the target demographic, and how they are able to contact the researchers if they decide to participate. Additionally, the researchers also sourced out potential participants from their friends, acquaintances, and classmates.
2. The second stage is obtaining their consent. Prior to the online interview, the researchers will disseminate an informed consent form to participants so they are informed about the purpose, risks, and other necessary information to gain insight into what they signed up for.
3. After the consent is obtained, the researchers will allot five to ten minutes for a brief, informal conversation with the participants to establish rapport. This conversation will allow the participant to become more at ease with the researchers since the interview may potentially evoke strong emotions.
4. Fourth, the semi-structured interview will begin. The participant will be given approximately thirty minutes to answer the interview questions. While the interview is ongoing, the researchers may ask follow-up questions if a part of the experience of the participant needs clarification.

5. Finally, once the interviews are concluded, the researchers will debrief the participants and remind them that the information collected will be solely used for research purposes and that their responses will be held with utmost confidentiality.

Distress Protocol

Distress protocols are set to provide a structured way to assess and suitably respond to participant distress, to ensure that the reactions are safely managed without any effect from the researchers' countertransference. By establishing protocols for the research, it offers clear instructions to handle adverse reactions during interviews (Whitney, 2022). When managing sensitive topics during the interview, all participants should be able to receive details of local support services after, in preparation if they want to discuss it further to a trained professional about the emotional and personal issues that come up (UK Statistics Authority, 2022). The role of the researchers does not extend to providing professional counseling; however, can provide appropriate support services and hotlines if necessary.

Ethical Considerations

All individuals participating in the research are to be treated with respect and complete assurance, as they volunteer their time. The research is designed and to be carried out with consideration for the dignity of participants, regardless of their sex, age, race, religion, lifestyle, and political beliefs. Prior to any data collection, the researchers are to obtain voluntary informed consent from the participants. The informed consent letter shall include explanations of the primary objectives of the study and key ethical considerations. To protect participant anonymity and privacy of the data being collected; All information must be managed and stored in compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012, all written documentation and audio recordings are to be kept in a secure location that only the researchers only have strict access to (National Privacy Commission, 2024).

The researchers recognize that discussing parental separation may evoke emotional responses. Family disruptions and inter-parental conflict can have lasting psychological effects, making such discussions sensitive (D'Onofrio & Emery, 2019; Syahdariani, 2025). Interviews will be conducted with attention to participants' emotional boundaries, allowing them to skip questions or withdraw at any time. These procedures ensure participant well-being while enabling the collection of authentic qualitative data (UK Statistics Authority, 2022; Whitney, 2022).

Data Analysis Methods

The study will use thematic analysis to identify and interpret recurring patterns within the data that will be collected. With this inductive approach, it ensures that researchers set aside their own biases and assumptions to allow significant themes in the study to emerge naturally. The process will involve remaining attentive to the experiences of young adults with separated parents during the data collection, and generate possible themes through brainstorming, and creating preliminary statements that shall evolve into a finalized model (Naeem et al., 2023).

The researchers will systematically code the transcripts, highlighting key statements, emotions, and reflections relevant to co-parenting dynamics, coping strategies, and the subjective experiences. These codes will then be clustered into broader themes that reflect both shared and unique experiences across participants. To ensure trustworthiness of the findings, the study will incorporate techniques such as peer debriefing, member checking, and reflective journaling, allowing the researchers to confirm that the themes accurately represent participants' perspectives and to reduce potential interpretive bias (Cresswell & Poth, 2018). This approach ensures that the analysis remains both systematic and credible to the phenomenological focus of the study.

References

American Psychological Association. (2025). Resilience. *American Psychological Association*. https://www.apa.org/topics/resilience

APA. (2026). APA Dictionary of Psychology. Apa.org. https://dictionary.apa.org/marital-separation

APA PsycNet. (2026). Apa.org. https://psycnet.apa.org/record/2022-00075-000

Awiszus, A., Koenig, M., & Vaisarova, J. (2022). Parenting Styles and Their Effect on Child Development and Outcome. *Journal of Student Research*, *11*(3). https://doi.org/10.47611/jsrhs.v11i3.3679

Chaulagain, A., Kunwar, A., Watts, S., Guerrero A., & Skokauskas, N. (2019). Child and adolescent mental health problems in Nepal: A scoping review. Int J Ment Health Syst, 13(53). https://doi.org/10.1186/s13033-019-0310-y

Creswell, J. W., & Poth, C. N. (2018). Qualitative inquiry and research design: Choosing among five approaches (4th ed.). *Sage Publications.* https://collegepublishing.sagepub.com/products/qualitative-inquiry-and-research-design-4-246896

Creswell, J. W. (2013). Qualitative inquiry and research design: Choosing among five approaches (3rd ed.). SAGE Publications. https://collegepublishing.sagepub.com/products/qualitative-inquiry-and-research-design-3-235677

D'Onofrio, B., & Emery, R. (2019b). Parental Divorce or Separation and children's Mental Health. *World Psychiatry*, *18*(1), 100–101. https://doi.org/10.1002/wps.20590

Hess, S. (2022). Effects of inter-parental conflict on children's social well-being and the mediation role of parenting behavior. Applied Research in Quality of Life, 17, 2059-2085.https://doi.org/10.1007/s11482-021-10022-y

Hutchinson, J. (2025). *Attachment theory | EBSCO*. EBSCO Information Services, Inc. | https://www.ebsco.com/research-starters/psychology/attachment-theory

Grotan, K., Sund, E.R., & Bjerkeset, O. (2019). Mental health, academic self-efficacy and study progress among college students –the shot study, Norway.Frontiers in Psychology, 10. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2019.00045

Johnsen, I.O., Litland, A.S., & Hallstrom, I.K. (2018). Living in two worlds –children's experiences after their parents' divorce –a qualitative study.Journal of Pediatric Nursing,43,44-51.https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pedn.2018.09.003

Kouros, C. D. (2020, October 20). Parental conflict effect on children. Child and Family Blog. https://childandfamilyblog.com/parental-conflict-effect-on-children/

Kretchmar, J. (2021). *Cognitive Dissonance Theory | EBSCO*. EBSCO Information Services, Inc. Www.ebsco.com. https://www.ebsco.com/research-starters/social-sciences-and-humanities/cognitive-dissonance-theory

Malolos, G.Z.C., Baron, M.B.C., Apat, F.A.J., Sagsagat, H.A.A., Pasco, P.B.M., Aportadera, E.T.C.L., Tan, R.J.D., Gacutno-Evardone, A.J. & Lucero-Prisno, D.E. (2021). Mental health and well-being of children in the philippine setting during the covid-19 pandemic. Health Promot Perspect, 11(3), 267-270. https://doi.org/10.34172%2Fhpp.2021.3

Moustakas, C. (1994). *Phenomenological research methods*. Sagepub.com. https://methods.sagepub.com/book/mono/phenomenological-research-methods/toc

Naeem, M., Ozuem, W., Howell, K., & Ranfagni, S. (2023). A step-by-step process of thematic analysis to develop a conceptual model in qualitative research. *International Journal of Qualitative Methods*, *22*(1), 1–18. https://doi.org/10.1177/16094069231205789

National Privacy Commission. (2024, June 14). *The data privacy act and its IRR*. National Privacy Commission. https://privacy.gov.ph/the-data-privacy-act-and-its-irr/

Nwanamidwa, P., & Ramatswi, T. T. (2025). The impact of co-parenting on children: how shared parenting affects child development and mental health in Vhembe District Municipality, South Africa. *International Journal of Business Ecosystem & Strategy (2687-2293)*, *7*(4), 232–241. https://doi.org/10.36096/ijbes.v7i4.888

Qiao, T., Wang, L., Chang, J., Huang, X., Wang, X., & Ye, P. (2024). The Effect of Paternal Co-Parenting on Preschool Children's Problem Behaviors: The Chain-Mediating Role of Maternal Parenting Burnout and Psychological Aggression. *Psychology Research and Behavior Management*, *17*, 187–200. https://doi.org/10.2147/PRBM.S451878

Sabillo, C. I. P. (2024). Parental separation: An exploration on learner's psychosocial well-being. *International Journal of Multidisciplinary Research and Analysis*, *7*(3). https://doi.org/doi.org/10.47191/ijmra/v7-i03-04

Sadowski, C., & McIntosh, J. E. (2016). On laughter and loss: Children's views of shared time, parenting and security post-separation. Childhood, 23(1), 69–86. https://doi.org/10.1177/0907568215570072.

Siguan, A., Ong, M.F.T., & Cañete, S.I.M. (2021). The impact of infidelity on Filipino family dynamics and young adult Filipino's self-concept. Malim: Jurnal Pengajian Umum Asia Tenggara, 22, 14 –37.https://doi.org/10.17576/malim-2021-2201-02

Syahdariani, E. (2025). Well-Being in Children Who Experience Broken Home: A Systematic Review. *International Journal of Educational and Psychological Sciences*, *3*(4), 485–498. https://doi.org/10.59890/ijeps.v3i4.106

UK Statistics Authority. (2022, May 25). *Ethical considerations associated with qualitative research methods*. UK Statistics Authority. https://uksa.statisticsauthority.gov.uk/publication/ethical-considerations-associated-with-qualitative-research-methods/pages/4/#pid-participant-distress-protocols

Whitney, C. (2022). The qualitative research distress protocol: A participant-centered tool for navigating distress during data collection. *International Journal of Qualitative Methods*, *21*(1), 160940692211103. Sage Journals. https://doi.org/10.1177/16094069221110317

"Growing Up Between Two Homes": A Phenomenological Study of the Lived Experiences of Young Adults from Co-Parenting Families After Parental Separation

Informed Consent Form

Introduction and Purpose of the Study

The purpose of the phenomenological study is to examine the lived experiences of young adults raised in co-parenting arrangements after their parents' separation. While existing studies have addressed the broader effects of parental separation on children, limited attention has been given on how it shapes psychological outcomes, particularly from the perspective of navigating life between two households. Accordingly, this study aims to investigate the lived experiences of young Filipino adults in Manila specifically in University Belt, with the goal of understanding their various experiences with co-parenting.

Prior to agreeing to take part in the study, please read thoroughly the following information. This section outlines the purpose of the research and why your participation is valuable. For any questions and concerns, please do not hesitate to contact the researchers.

Study Procedures

The study will utilize a quantitative phenomenological research design to explore the lived experiences of young adults from co-parenting families after parental separation. Participants who meet the inclusion criteria will be invited to take part in a one-on-one semi-structured interview conducted through an online platform.

During the interview, participants will be asked open-ended questions related to their experiences growing up between two households, their emotional adjustments, possible coping mechanisms, relationships with parents; and perceptions of the relationship of their parents. The interview is expected to last approximately 30 to 60 minutes and will be recorded with the participant's consent to ensure accurate transcription and data analysis.

After data collection, the recorded interview will be transcribed verbatim. The researchers will analyze the data using thematic analysis to identify common themes and patterns that reflect the participants' lived experiences. All information collected will be confidential and used solely for academic and research purposes.

Duration

The interview is solely conversational on an online platform. The exact duration may vary upon the meeting as it is composed of open-ended questions, which can take approximately 30 to 60 minutes of your time. The interviews will be conducted individually with an outline of important topics and questions to be explored, maintaining focus and consistency. The interview will take place via Google Meet with a date and time of your preference and convenience. Upon completing the interview, there will be no follow-up sessions.

Voluntary Participation

Your participation in this study is completely voluntary. You are free to decide whether or not you want to take part in this research. If you agree to participate, you may refuse to answer any question that you find uncomfortable, too personal, or emotionally difficult. You have the right to stop the interview or withdraw from the study at any point without needing to provide a reason and without any penalty, disadvantage or negative consequence. If any part of the interview triggers unpleasant thoughts or emotions, you may choose to pause, skip questions or discontinue your participation. The researchers are committed to respecting the participant's autonomy, boundaries, and decisions at every stage of the study.

Risks

The questions in the interview may trigger strong emotions such as feelings of anxiety, anger, guilt, sadness, or distress when recalling past experiences. Additionally, it is possible that the participants will experience emotional fatigue when expressing their personal experiences. While the acquired information will remain confidential within the researchers and professors, there are minimal risks that sensitive data can accidentally be stolen, disclosed, or hacked, especially when information is stored digitally.

Benefits

The study may benefit participants by providing them with an opportunity to express and reflect on their personal experiences in a safe and confidential environment. Sharing their stories may promote emotional awareness, validation of feelings, and personal reflection. Through participation, individuals may gain deeper insights into how their experiences shaped their psychological well-being and coping strategies. It allows participants to

contribute to research that highlights the voices and experiences of young adults from co-parenting families.

Additionally, the study may contribute to the following other benefits:

- Contribute to academic literature on psychological well-being and co-parenting families after parental separation.
- Provide insights that may help develop improved counseling interventions and mental health support programs.
- Assist educators, psychologists, and family practitioners in better understanding the challenges and needs of individuals from separated families.
- Support future research that aims to strengthen family-based interventions and coping support systems.

Incentives

As a token of gratitude for your participation and contribution of your time in the study, participants shall receive an incentive of ₱100 that will be credited to your GCash account upon completion of the interview.

Confidentiality

In accordance with the Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act of 2012), the researchers strictly adheres to all provisions and its implementing rules and regulations, as well as the National Privacy Commission (NPC) issuances. To protect the integrity, confidentiality, and privacy of all collected information in this research, the study uses data security measures. This includes the use of pseudonyms to mask identities, generalizing demographic details, and storing all digital transcripts and audio recordings in a restricted-access google drive. These protocols ensure the continuous protection of your personal narratives and research data against unauthorized access, disclosure, or breaches, with all files being securely and permanently deleted after a maximum period of six months.

Contact Information

If you have any concerns and questions at any time of the study, or if you have any experiences as a result of participation, you may contact the researchers whose contact information is provided below.

Researchers:

Crisostomo, Gia

Email Address: giacrisostomo1@gmail.com

Dela Cruz, Georgine Kyla

Email Address: delacruzgeorginek@gmail.com

Geneta, Geanille C.

Email Address: ggeanille@gmail.com

Geronimo, Xynith Jigary M.

Email Address: geronimoxynith@gmail.com

Mena, Cyrin Grace M.

Email Address: cyringrace18@gmail.com

Verayo, Rayzel Ann M.

Email Address: raverayo23@gmail.com

For further assistance, you may contact the following 24/7 mental health hotlines:

National Center for Mental Health (NCMH)

- Landline (Toll-free): 1553
- Mobile (Smart/TNT): 1800-1888-1553 | 0919-057-1553 | 0966-351-4518
- Mobile (Globe/TM): 0917-899-8727
- Landline: (02) 8989-8727

Hopeline (Natasha Goulbourn Foundation)

- Landline: (02) 8804-4673
- Mobile (Smart): 0918-873-4673
- Mobile (Globe/TM): 0917-558-4673 | 2919 (Toll-free)

In-Touch Community Services Crisis Hotline

- Landline: (02) 8893-7603

- Mobile (Globe): 0917-800-1123

Manila Lifeline Centre

- Landline: (02) 896-9191
- Mobile (Globe): 0917-854-9191

Dial-A-Friend

- Landline: (02) 8525-1743 | (02) 8525-1881

Mood Harmony (Makati Medical Center)

- Landline: (02) 8844-2941

CONSENT FORM

I have carefully read the provided information, or have been read to me. I have had the opportunity to ask questions about the research and any questions I have asked have been answered to my satisfaction. I fully understand that I will be given a copy of this form, and the researchers will keep another copy of the file. I consent voluntarily to be a participant of this research study.

Printed Name of Participant:_____

Signature of Participant:_____

Date (Month/Day/Year):_____